

GDD

I'm using this GGD template as a reference/inspiration [IA GDD Template](#)

Overview

Concept (In progress, sprint 1)

Timeplex is a 2D puzzle game that manipulates time to solve complex challenges. Building upon the original idea of [Timeplex](#), this version expands the puzzles, introduces a reworked narrative, and updates the art style. It explores themes of trauma, self-reflection, and healing through a unique gameplay mechanic where players control multiple characters across different timelines simultaneously.

The game offers a blend of strategic puzzle-solving and an emotionally charged story. Players guide Erma, an older woman trapped in a mental institution, as she navigates through a maze of memories and parallel timelines. The central gameplay mechanic involves managing four distinct versions of Erma, each from a different period in her life, all working together to unlock her past and progress through puzzles.

The story unfolds through comic-style cutscenes and interactions with the environment, with each version of Erma offering different perspectives and emotional responses to key moments. The game's art style is minimalistic and flat, providing a clean and focused aesthetic that complements the serious and introspective narrative. Timeplex is designed to challenge players' puzzle-solving abilities while exploring deep psychological and emotional themes.

Style

Timeplex is a 2D top-down puzzle game based on grid movement. It consists of a Menu, Levels, and Cutscenes between Levels. The visual style is cartoony-colored without an outline. The texture is flat and minimalistic.

- In Levels, the layer's screen is split evenly into up to four Frames. Each frame represents one of four timelines, and the character and environment art are different. Each frame has its own grid map, background art, and inventory UI.
- Cutscenes are presented in a comic-style format with programmed pop-up effects, displaying sequential comic panels.

Features (In progress, sprint 1)

Timeplex is a Sokoban game that controls 4 characters at the same time.

1. What is the main mechanic?

2. What is the theme?
3. How large is the scope?

Programming

Please refer to the technical design document linked below.

 [Timeplex Technical Design Document](#)

Management

Links:

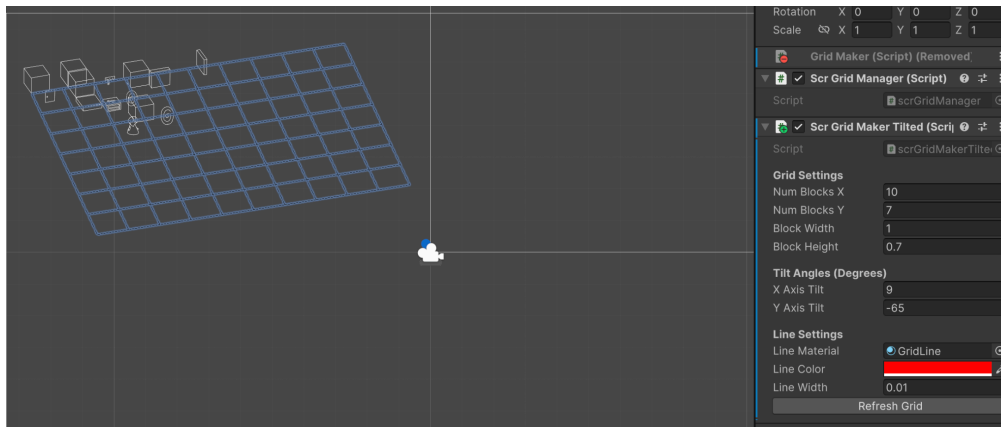
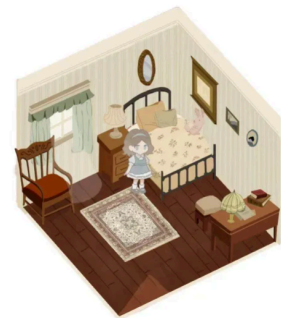
Brainstorm Board: <https://app.milanote.com/1TCtcc1tBJMI7c/timeplex?p=vWwJ1sbqrxv>

BackLog & Task Managements:  [MSS Timeplex](#)

Art

Timeplex is a 2D game with isometric levels, comic-style cutscenes, and a menu. The art style is (In progress, sprint 1).

Art reference board: <https://pin.it/1da2BWbMG>



Grid Reference Setting (Shown Above)

Artists' Grid System Tutorial: 📺 [how to use grid.mov](#)

Art Asset List: 📁 [Big To-do](#)

Submission folder: 📁 [TimeplexArtAssets](#) *For final assets that will be used in the game, submit in Google Drive folder first, then push to GitHub in Assets/Sprite/NewFolderName.

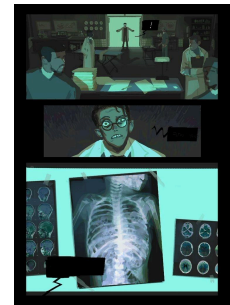
Levels

During the level, the screen is divided into 1 to 4 smaller sections, each representing a room from a timeline. This is the primary area where puzzles occur, and players will spend most of their time with this view.

1. **Perspective:** Isometric grids. Grid ref:
2. **Style:** 📁 [concept room.png](#)
3. **Assets:**
 - a. Ground + wall tiles
 - b. Props (Furniture, ...)
 - c. Characters: Each character has 4 idle sprites facing 4 directions. Characters include Non-Player Characters and 4 Player Characters from 4 timelines.
📁 [Concept_Erma\(3_years_old\).PNG](#)

Cutscenes

Cutscenes are presented in a comic-style format with programmed pop-up effects, displaying sequential comic panels. They appear between levels to enhance storytelling.



UI

1. Menu: (In progress)
2. Inventory: The inventory has a limited capacity of 0 to 1 slots. Items collected by the player are displayed as sprites above the character holding them. Since the game features multiple screens, there will be 4 separate inventory UIs.

Story

Detailed Story Doc: [Narrative Document](#)

Overview

The story of Timeplex revolves around Erma, an old woman who comes to terms with her past through a distorted view, which at first presents itself to the audience as a time loop. As she escapes the mental institute where she grew up through movement-based puzzles, she unlocks memories and takes the first step towards healing.

With this narrative, we intend to portray the complexities of the mind and the way it deals with trauma in interesting ways. The varied versions of herself at different stages of her time in the facility come to reveal the truth of the situation, symbolizing Erma's reflection on the past and her eventual acceptance of it as each of her selves manages to escape with her. It is a historical piece that highlights the truth of mental facilities in the past and notes that while things have changed over time, they are still not perfect.

Look and Feel

(In Progress, Sprint 1)

How is the story conveyed

The most instrumental parts of the narrative of Timeplex will be communicated through 3-4 short, comic-like **cutscenes**. Outside of the cutscenes mentioned, the narrative will be portrayed through simple **interactable object text**. As such, the objects and the environment will play a large role in the story we want to tell—especially with the consideration that different versions of Erma will have different reactions to various objects (i.e. 20-year-old Erma would see a hydrotherapy chamber and easily recall her rage/fear about it, while 80-year old Erma would not entirely understand why she felt so unsettled by it).

- **Cutscene:** (In Progress, Sprint 2)
- **Interactable Object Text:** (In Progress, Sprint 2)

Back Story

Plot Element

Locations

Characters

- **Player Character: Erma**
(In Progress, Sprint 2)
- **Non-Player Characters**
(In Progress, Sprint 2)

Mechanics

Puzzle

Player Character

Re-do Button

Redo last step.

Inventory

Any player character or NPC may hold up to one object. The object is displayed above the player's head as a 2D sprite, moving with them.

Non-Player Character

All NPCs can interact with objects and have an inventory just like the Player Characters. They move based on rules after the player on each timeline, on their turn.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

NPC type 1

This NPC performs the same moves the player does in its timeline, unless blocked by collision or interaction.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

NPC type 2

This NPC performs the mirrored movement of the player in its timeline, unless blocked by collision.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

NPC type 3

This NPC is stationary and rotates based on the player's movement. It has a sight line marked by a flashlight. If the player is caught in said sight line it moves towards the player, 3 tiles each turn.

NPC type 4

This NPC follows along a set path each turn, unless the player steps in its sight line. When that happens the NPC moves towards the player 3 tiles each turn.

Environment

Doors

Doors are passageways between sublevels that have unlimited use. All player characters must be on the same type of door tile to go to the connected sublevel. No two player characters may use the same door, and if there are less doors than characters the player must incapacitate player characters until they have the correct amount. One room may contain multiple doors.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

Portals

Portals are passageways between timelines. Any character (NPC or PC) that steps on them will be transported to the connected window's portal. This will not happen if: the connected portal is occupied already, or if the portal's number of uses is at 0. Portal uses are displayed as a numeric value on the portal in question. Only the portal travelled from decreases in uses.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

Interactable Objects

Timeline Frames

Timeline Swap

Clicking on two different timeline windows in succession will swap their location. This does not affect the player character's sprite, but affects the surrounding environment and player character location.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

Timeline Continuity

If an interactable object or NPC gets a status applied to them, it will affect all following timelines on screen. If a timeline where the object is in a new state is swapped to be earlier on, any later timelines also get the effect applied to them.

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

~~Timeline Unlocked Objects~~

~~Some objects are only visible when their timeline is placed in the correct spot.~~

[GRAPH EXAMPLES]

Mechanics Progression order:

1. Movement
2. Doors / Sublevels
3. Object Interaction
4. Connected Movement
5. Level End Door
6. Timeline Swap
7. Timeline Continuity
8. Portals

Mechanic

Sokoban where the player controls four characters in different timelines...

Map

Connected room(small)

Level Design Workflow

Original tutorial vid: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vl13AkCp928>